



Based in San Francisco



EDUCATION

BSC ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING

2016 – 2019 · University of Cape Town

- Graduated with First Class Honours as the top BSc(Eng) student.
- Awarded the prize for the best final-year thesis.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Go, Python, SQL, Git, Docker, gRPC

DOMAINS

Distributed systems · P2P networks · event-driven systems & pipelines · protocol design · database migrations · code review at scale

Outside of work, you can find me in the mountains, looking for rocks to climb, photo hunting, practicing calisthenics, or spending time with friends.

Contact me for references.

Elle Mouton

Backend Software Engineer

About

Backend engineer with 5+ years building distributed systems, most of it on Bitcoin's Lightning Network at [Lightning Labs](#): protocol upgrades and large database migrations shipped across a live network of thousands of independently run nodes. Before that, event-driven microservices at [Luno](#), handling crypto volumes for millions of users.

Interested in agentic loops, AI tooling, and event-driven systems.

Experience

⚡ Lightning Infrastructure Engineer | Lightning Labs

2021 – 2026

- Top contributor to [LND](#), the most widely-deployed Bitcoin L2; led developer-tooling work on [Lightning Node Connect](#) and [Lightning Terminal](#).
- Core contributor to [Wavelength](#), a self-custodial bitcoin payments toolkit unifying Ark, Lightning swaps and on-chain wallets for apps and agents.
- Shipped protocol upgrades and large database migrations safely across a live peer-to-peer network of thousands of nodes; led the multi-PR [epic](#) moving LND's graph database to SQL.
- Delivered significant performance improvements — e.g. [~28x on a graph query](#) and [~400x on a filter sync](#).
- Authored public protocol specification extensions ([BLIP-0039 gossip protocol BOLT extension](#)).

🔵 Software Engineer | Luno

2020 – 2021

Backend engineer on the crypto-operations team. Worked in Go on event-driven microservices handling high cryptocurrency volumes for millions of users.

Writing

Deep-dive technical posts on Bitcoin and Lightning Network internals, widely read across the community. ellemouton.com/articles →

Public Appearances



Advancing Bitcoin,
London



Connect The World
Podcast



The Chaincode Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin++ Brazil